Language Arts Exam # 1 - Middle Grades
2024-25 Governor's Cup Practice Questions

Student Instructions:

- Write your complete ID code on your answer sheet.
- If you change your answer, erase well.

1. To which of the following does the title of Stephen Crane's *The Red Badge of Courage* refer?
   A. a flag
   B. a battle wound
   C. a rose
   D. a military medal

2. Which character below did Herman Melville NOT create?
   A. Chingachgook
   B. Billy Budd
   C. Queequeg
   D. Typee

3. They may be the fictional equivalents of the Hatfields and McCoys. Which of the following choices names the feuding families Huck encounters in *The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn*?
   A. Douglases and Watsons
   B. Harrises and Potters
   C. Lokers and Conklins
   D. Grangerfords and Shepherdsons

4. Which choice below names the protagonist of Louis Sachar's Newbery Medal-winning novel *Holes*?
   A. Leigh Botts
   B. Bud Caldwell
   C. Stanley Yelnats
   D. Turtle Wexler

5. Which one of the following Newbery-winning novels did the author set in Nazi-occupied Denmark during World War Two?
   A. *Criss Cross*
   B. *Number the Stars*
   C. *The View from Saturday*
   D. *Out of the Dust*

6. Below are four Newbery Medal-winning authors. Which one partly based the title character of her novel *Caddie Woodlawn* on her grandmother?
   A. Carol Ryrie Brink
   B. Phyllis Reynolds Naylor
   C. Ann Nolan Clark
   D. Elizabeth George Speare

7. Which one of the following Newbery winners is a series of poems meant to be read aloud?
   A. *A Gathering of Days*
   B. *Up a Road Slowly*
   C. *The Whipping Boy*
   D. *Joyful Noise*

8. Gary Paulsen named a novel about Brian Robeson's survival in the wilderness after what tool?
   A. hacksaw
   B. tomahawk
   C. hatchet
   D. machete

9. In *Where the Red Fern Grows* by Wilson Rawls, Old Dan and Little Ann are what kind of animal?
   A. sheep
   B. dogs
   C. chickens
   D. cats

10. Match each *Alice's Adventures in Wonderland* character with his or her quotation.

x. The Mad Hatter	1. "How is a raven like a writing-desk?"
y. The Duchess	2. "We're all mad here."
z. The Cheshire Cat	3. "Everything's got a moral, if only you can find it."

   A. x-3, y-2, z-1
   B. x-3, y-1, z-2
   C. x-2, y-3, z-1
   D. x-1, y-3, z-2

11. In a Newbery Honor Book by Gennifer Choldenko, Moose Flanagan claims that which of the following gangsters "does my shirts"?
   A. Al Capone
   B. Baby Face Nelson
   C. John Dillinger
   D. Bugsy Siegel

12. She earned a Scott O'Dell Award for *Butterfly Yellow*. Which author below won a National Book Award and Newbery Honor for her first novel, *Inside Out and Back Again*?
   A. Lisa Yee
   B. Grace Lin
   C. Thanhhà Lại
   D. Traci Chee

13. Which one of the following Edwards Award-winning authors earned that honor for books like *Ask the Passengers* and *Please Ignore Vera Dietz*?
   A. Sharon Draper
   B. A. S. King
   C. Laurie Halse Anderson
   D. Angela Johnson

14. Seen here is the cover art of a Sibert Honor biography of Carlos Santana. What is its title?
   A. *This Strange Wilderness*
   B. *Sweet Justice*
   C. *Star Child*
   D. *When Angels Sing*

15. Below are four Russian composers. Which one is the subject of M. T. Anderson's nonfiction book *Symphony for the City of the Dead*?
    A. Igor Stravinsky
    B. Sergei Prokofiev
    C. Dmitri Shostakovich
    D. Pyotr Tchaikovsky

16. Kadir Nelson's King Author Award- and Sibert Medal-winning book *We Are the Ship* profiles early African-American professional athletes in which sport below?
    A. baseball
    B. basketball
    C. soccer
    D. football

17. Edna St. Vincent Millay wrote which of the following poetic lines?
    A. "My candle burns at both ends; / It will not last the night…"
    B. "The land was ours before we were the land's."
    C. "Let America be America again. / Let it be the dream it used to be."
    D. "Rage, rage against the dying of the light."

18. In 1903, Emma Lazarus's poem "The New Colossus" was inscribed on a bronze plaque now located inside which landmark below?
    A. Mount Rushmore
    B. Statue of Liberty
    C. Washington Monument
    D. Lincoln Memorial

19. By its final publication, which of the following Walt Whitman poems consisted of 52 sections and over 1,300 lines?
    A. "I Hear America Singing"
    B. "When Lilacs Last in the Dooryard Bloom'd"
    C. "O Captain! My Captain!"
    D. "Song of Myself"

20. Match each man with his speech.

x. Patrick Henry	1. "A More Perfect Union"
y. Malcolm X	2. "Shall Liberty or Empire Be Sought?"
z. Barack Obama	3. "By Any Means Necessary"

    A. x-1, y-3, z-2
    B. x-2, y-1, z-3
    C. x-3, y-2, z-1
    D. x-2, y-3, z-1

21. William Shakespeare created three of the following characters. Which one did J. M. Barrie create?
    A. Puck
    B. Oberon
    C. Smee
    D. Bottom

22. Below are four U.S. Army generals. Which one delivered a 1962 address titled “Duty, Honor, Country” to West Point cadets?
    A. Douglas MacArthur
    B. George Marshall
    C. Dwight Eisenhower
    D. George Patton

23. The poet of “This Is Just to Say” also wrote which one of the following short stories?
    A. “The Third Wish”
    B. “The Use of Force”
    C. “The Treasure of Lemon Brown”
    D. “The Two Brothers”

24. He recounted a humorous childhood incident in “The Night the Bed Fell.” Which man below created a daydreamer in “The Secret Life of Walter Mitty”?
    A. W. W. Jacobs
    B. James Thurber
    C. Stephen Vincent Benét
    D. Daniel Keyes

25. Which one of the following animals plays a role in Mona Gardner’s story “The Dinner Party”?
    A. tiger
    B. mongoose
    C. swan
    D. cobra

26. Born in present-day Pittsburgh, he was an Ohio Valley Indian scout who possibly died in a feud with a trapper. Which choice below names this keelboatman and inspiration for a boasting, hard-drinking tall tale character?
    A. Mike Fink
    B. Cordwood Pete
    C. Casey Jones
    D. John Henry

27. Which of the following Aesop fables teaches the reader, “Do not grudge others what you cannot enjoy yourself”?
    A. “The Fox and the Grapes”
    B. “The Tortoise and the Hare”
    C. “The Dog in the Manger”
    D. “The Town Mouse and the Country Mouse”

28. Her Welsh counterpart is the witch of Rhibyn. Irish folklore claims that which supernatural being below wails to foretell a death in the family of the person who hears her?
    A. siren
    B. jinn
    C. zombie
    D. banshee

29. An appositive phrase is part of which of the following sentences?
   A. The only state that was once its own country, Texas has a unique history.
   B. Crying loudly and frequently, the newborn prevented his parents from sleeping.
   C. He began reading more to improve his vocabulary.
   D. Painting colorful landscapes is his specialty.

30. Match each sentence type with its example.

x. I'm getting a puppy for my birthday!	1. exclamatory
y. American English and British English sometimes differ.	2. imperative
z. Don't touch that hot stove!	3. declarative

   A. x-1, y-2, z-3
   B. x-1, y-3, z-2
   C. x-2, y-3, z-1
   D. x-2, y-1, z-3

31. Which sentence below contains NO usage errors?
   A. That pack of hot dogs costs $1.99.
   B. She's a better clarinetist than him.
   C. Its too hot to go outside today.
   D. The amount of shark attacks is increasing.

32. "One of my neighbors traveled to Hawaii during the first week of July." How many prepositional phrases are in the previous sentence?
   A. 1
   B. 2
   C. 3
   D. 4

33. Which sentence below contains INCORRECT capitalization?
   A. Edgar Allan Poe set one of his short stories during the Spanish Inquisition.
   B. President Andrew Jackson's nickname was "Old Hickory."
   C. Chemical elements named for people include Einsteinium and Curium.
   D. The Grand Canyon is about three hours away from the Petrified Forest.

34. "After the team won the championship, I called my parents, and we made plans to celebrate." What is the previous sentence's grammatical structure?
   A. simple
   B. compound-complex
   C. compound
   D. complex

35. Which sentence below only uses hyphens CORRECTLY?
   A. The library's guest lecturer was not well-known.
   B. That actress is an Emmy-Award nominee.
   C. We accidentally drove down a one-way street.
   D. The correctly-tuned violin played beautifully.

36. Which of the following choices names the three degrees of adjectives and adverbs?
   A. first, second, and third
   B. coordinating, correlative, and subordinating
   C. subjective, objective, and possessive
   D. positive, comparative, and superlative

37. Which pronoun below is indefinite?
   A. many
   B. who
   C. yourself
   D. they

38. It is the English language's most common mood. Which grammatical mood below expresses facts or states opinions as if they are facts?
   A. interrogative
   B. imperative
   C. indicative
   D. subjunctive

39. Which one of the following words is MISSPELLED?
   A. deficient
   B. critique
   C. haphazzard
   D. accumulate

40. Match each word with its synonym.

x. copious	1. finicky
y. pungent	2. bountiful
z. fastidious	3. aromatic

   A. x-2, y-1, z-3
   B. x-2, y-3, z-1
   C. x-1, y-3, z-2
   D. x-3, y-2, z-1

41. Which word below is spelled CORRECTLY?
   A. iminent
   B. reverbarate
   C. tyrade
   D. feasible

42. Which one of the following words contains a Greek prefix meaning "many"?
   A. polytheism
   B. ambiguous
   C. macrobiotic
   D. transparent

43. Below are four suffixes. Which one is Latin for “state of” or “quality of” and often transforms a word into a noun?
    A. -wise
    B. -ize
    C. -ity
    D. -ic

44. The Latin root found in *recognize* and *cognition* means which of the following?
    A. work
    B. know
    C. break
    D. skill

45. Below are four Japanese words. Which one names a small grill used for outdoor cooking?
    A. wasabi
    B. futon
    C. tsunami
    D. hibachi

46. Which of the following Yiddish words can refer to a clumsy or foolish person?
    A. chutzpah
    B. maven
    C. klutz
    D. schmooze

47. Both the baby and the carrier seen here can be called what Native American word?
    A. papoose
    B. wigwam
    C. moccasin
    D. toboggan

48. Which of the following choices is NOT a type of irony?
    A. dramatic
    B. temporal
    C. verbal
    D. situational

49. Below are four literary devices. Which one, a relative of oxymoron, is a seemingly self-contradictory statement, such as, “I must be cruel only to be kind”?
    A. metonymy
    B. hyperbole
    C. euphemism
    D. paradox

50. Match each literary term with its description.

x. allusion	1. a speech that a character gives aloud, but not to another character
y. epiphany	2. a reference to a well-known person, place, character, or event
z. soliloquy	3. a moment of sudden realization

A. x-2, y-3, z-1
B. x-1, y-3, z-2
C. x-3, y-2, z-1
D. x-1, y-2, z-3

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1. B
2. A
3. D
4. C
5. B
6. A
7. D
8. C
9. B
10. D
11. A
12. C
13. B
14. D
15. C
16. A
17. A
18. B
19. D
20. D
21. C
22. A
23. B
24. B
25. D
26. A
27. C
28. D
29. A
30. B
31. A
32. D
33. C
34. B
35. C
36. D
37. A
38. C
39. C
40. B
41. D
42. A
43. C
44. B
45. D
46. C
47. A
48. B
49. D
50. A